



WHAT IS THIS?

Kanvaz is an infinite reference board for VFX and 3D artists — think of it as a digital pinboard where you can drop in images, GIFs, video clips, and audio tracks, arrange them freely, scribble notes and annotations directly on top, and keep everything organized across multiple boards. Built for breakdowns, mood boards, shot references, and anything you'd normally pin to a wall.

WHO MADE THIS

Made by Atharva Patil (Northbyte Studios), a fellow artist and student in Navi Mumbai. Kanvaz started as a personal tool for organizing VFX references and grew into something worth sharing with the people Atharva works and studies with — teachers, classmates, and friends in the same field.

KEY FEATURES

- **Infinite canvas**
Pan and zoom freely — 8% to 500%. Arrange hundreds of references with no fixed boundaries.
- **Drag, drop & paste**
Drop images, GIFs, video, and audio files straight from your file explorer, or paste images with Ctrl+V.
- **Annotate anything**
Draw, circle, and arrow directly on top of any card with pen, arrow, and rectangle tools in 6 colors.
- **Multiple boards**
Organize different projects or shot sequences into separate board tabs within one file.
- **Save & reload**
Everything — positions, annotations, zoom level — saves to a single .kanvaz file and restores exactly.
- **Mood lock**
Hide all UI chrome with one shortcut for distraction-free presenting or reviewing (Ctrl+Shift+F).

PRIVACY & OFFLINE

Kanvaz runs entirely on your machine. No accounts, no telemetry, no analytics, and no internet connection required — your boards, images, video, and audio never leave your computer unless you choose to share the file yourself.

Free & open source — yours to keep

Found a bug or have an idea? Feedback is genuinely welcome — just tell Atharva directly (Northbyte Studios).

Get the latest version: github.com/p4inz-code/kanvaz



Kanvaz

Quick Start Guide

GETTING STARTED

1

Open the app

Double-click the Kanvaz icon. On first launch you'll see a quick welcome screen — click through it to get to the canvas.

2

Add your media

Drag image, GIF, video, or audio files from your file explorer straight onto the canvas, or copy an image anywhere and press Ctrl+V to paste it.

3

Move, resize & annotate

Click and drag any card to move it. Drag the corner/edge handles to resize (hold Shift to resize freely). Right-click a card → "Annotate" to draw on top of it with pen, arrow, or rectangle tools.

4

Create & switch boards

Click the "+" next to your board tabs to create a new board. Double-click a tab name to rename it. Each board keeps its own cards, zoom, and position.

5

Save your work

Press Ctrl+S to save to a .kanvaz file. Ctrl+Shift+S saves a copy under a new name. Kanvaz also auto-saves every 30 seconds as a safety net.

TOP 5 SHORTCUTS

Space + Drag

Pan around the canvas

Scroll

Zoom in / out

ctrl + S

Save the current board

Ctrl + Shift + F

Mood lock — hide all UI for presenting

ctrl + Z

Undo (up to 50 steps)

PRO TIPS

Pin cards in place

Right-click any card and choose Pin (or press P) to lock its position so it can't be moved or nudged by accident.

Duplicate with Ctrl+D

Quickly clone the selected card — handy for creating variations or side-by-side comparisons.

Toggle annotations with H

Select an annotated card and press H to hide or show your pen, arrow, and rectangle marks without deleting them.

Found a bug? Have an idea?

Tell Atharva directly — that's it. This build is small enough that a quick message is the fastest way to get something fixed.